

RESEARCH PLAN — organised by decision, not by player

JUG, slot 8 · built Sep 02 2026, 03:50 · how I would spend the hours if they were mine

**What this is.** You get fourteen picks. At most five are real decisions — the rest the board has already settled, and reading about them changes nothing. This sheet says **which five**, and **what question to ask** at each.

- The numbers, in plain terms:**
- **VBD** — how many more fantasy points this player is worth *over the whole season* than someone at the same position you could pick up for free. Higher is better. Divide by 14 for points per week.
  - **the gap at the top of each pick** — how much better the best choice is than the second-best. **This is the point of the sheet.** 12 points over a season is under a point a week; 0.4 points is three hundredths of a point a week, which is nothing. For scale: a bye-week collision costs at most 1.2 points all year, and a good backup QB is worth 5 to 11. **Under ~3 points is a coin flip. 3 to 8 is worth an hour of reading. Over 15 and the pick makes itself.**
  - **% there** — the chance he is still on the board at your turn. It runs optimistic; he is often gone a pick sooner.
  - **played N of 17** — games he actually played last season. Missing real time last year predicts missing more this year.
  - **AVOID / hurt** — the injury sweep flagged him *and* expects him to miss games. Where the sweep still expects a full 17, it is a note rather than a warning and is not shown here.
  - **nobody owns this job yet** — the team’s own projections for its top two at that spot are close, meaning even the projection does not know who wins it. That is the opening. **Someone leads but the backup is close** is the softer version of the same thing.

EARLY — PICKS 8 TO 41 · ASK: “IS HE GOING TO BE ON THE FIELD?”

Up here, **92 out of 100 players turn into a useful starter**. You are not going to find a hidden gem — everyone can see these guys. The only way to lose is to draft someone who gets hurt. So the one thing worth checking is **how many games he played last year**: a receiver who missed real time last season misses about 4 more games the next one, and finishes roughly 16 points short of what the projection says. **Look at the games column and the injury flag. Skip everything else.**

|                                                                                                                    |    |     |     |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|-----|-----|--|
| PICK 8 · the top two are 12.4 points apart over the whole season (0.89 a week) <div>leaning, but not settled</div> |    |     |     |  |
| Christian McCaffrey                                                                                                | RB | 135 | 47% |  |
| Jonathan Taylor                                                                                                    | RB | 123 | 43% |  |
| Jaxon Smith-Njigba                                                                                                 | WR | 105 | 37% |  |
| Amon-Ra St. Brown                                                                                                  | WR | 101 | 52% |  |

|                                                                                                                     |    |    |     |                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|-----|---------------------------------|
| PICK 17 · the top two are 12.0 points apart over the whole season (0.86 a week) <div>leaning, but not settled</div> |    |    |     |                                 |
| Derrick Henry                                                                                                       | RB | 95 | 54% |                                 |
| Saquon Barkley                                                                                                      | RB | 83 | 38% | played 16 of 17 games last year |
| Kenneth Walker III                                                                                                  | RB | 81 | 79% |                                 |
| Josh Allen                                                                                                          | QB | 80 | 69% | played 16 of 17 games last year |

|                                                                                                                                             |    |    |     |                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PICK 32 · the top two are 4.9 points apart over the whole season (0.35 a week) <div>TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday</div> |    |    |     |                                                                                               |
| Kyren Williams                                                                                                                              | RB | 47 | 51% | someone leads but the backup is close, job worth 215 points                                   |
| Quinshon Judkins                                                                                                                            | RB | 42 | 77% | played 14 of 17 games last year · someone leads but the backup is close, job worth 211 points |
| Garrett Wilson                                                                                                                              | WR | 36 | 40% | played 7 of 17 games last year                                                                |
| Davante Adams                                                                                                                               | WR | 35 | 59% | played 14 of 17 games last year                                                               |

|                                                                                                                                             |    |    |     |                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PICK 41 · the top two are 6.6 points apart over the whole season (0.47 a week) <div>TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday</div> |    |    |     |                                                                                                        |
| D'Andre Swift                                                                                                                               | RB | 28 | 43% | played 16 of 17 games last year · nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 196 points to whoever wins it |
| Matthew Stafford                                                                                                                            | QB | 21 | 96% |                                                                                                        |
| Bhayshul Tuten                                                                                                                              | RB | 20 | 72% | played 15 of 17 games last year · someone leads but the backup is close, job worth 188 points          |
| Rome Odunze                                                                                                                                 | WR | 19 | 62% | played 12 of 17 games last year                                                                        |

MIDDLE — PICKS 56 TO 89 · ASK: “WHY DOES IT KEEP OFFERING ME A QB?”

Look at the names below: Stafford, Stafford, Purdy, Mahomes. That is not the market telling you quarterbacks are cheap — it is **our board rating quarterbacks and tight ends higher than everybody else does**. We measured it: our board puts QBs about 16 spots and TEs about 18 spots ahead of where the expert consensus has them. Boone and Harmon lean the other way by roughly the same amount, and your own mock kept handing you Stafford.

**How you correct it: at a close call in this zone, take the running back or receiver.** Not because the QB is bad, but because if you miss on a QB you can grab another off waivers — that works 62% of the time. Miss on a running back and you are stuck: waivers bail you out 22% of the time.

PICK 56 · the top two are 9.3 points apart over the whole season (0.66 a week) leaning, but not settled

|                    |    |    |             |                                                                                                          |
|--------------------|----|----|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Matthew Stafford   | QB | 21 | 75%         |                                                                                                          |
| Jadarian Price     | RB | 12 | 40%         | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 180 points to whoever wins it                                     |
| TreVeyon Henderson | RB | 9  | 59%<br>hurt | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 182 points to whoever wins it · sweep expects him to miss 1 games |
| Sam LaPorta        | TE | 9  | 38%<br>hurt | played 9 of 17 games last year · sweep expects him to miss 1 games                                       |

PICK 65 · the top two are 13.8 points apart over the whole season (0.99 a week) leaning, but not settled

|                  |    |    |     |                                |
|------------------|----|----|-----|--------------------------------|
| Matthew Stafford | QB | 21 | 50% |                                |
| Bo Nix           | QB | 7  | 69% |                                |
| Courtland Sutton | WR | 6  | 37% |                                |
| Brock Purdy      | QB | 5  | 89% | played 9 of 17 games last year |

PICK 80 · the top two are 2.0 points apart over the whole season (0.14 a week) TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday

|                 |    |   |             |                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|----|---|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brock Purdy     | QB | 5 | 59%         | played 9 of 17 games last year                                                                           |
| Rico Dowdle     | RB | 3 | 44%         | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 171 points to whoever wins it                                     |
| Tony Pollard    | RB | 2 | 41%<br>hurt | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 171 points to whoever wins it · sweep expects him to miss 1 games |
| Patrick Mahomes | QB | 2 | 62%         | played 14 of 17 games last year                                                                          |

PICK 89 · the top two are 2.5 points apart over the whole season (0.18 a week) TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday

|                 |    |    |              |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|----|----|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brock Purdy     | QB | 5  | 37%          | played 9 of 17 games last year                                                                                                                                      |
| Patrick Mahomes | QB | 2  | 40%          | played 14 of 17 games last year                                                                                                                                     |
| Mark Andrews    | TE | 0  | 74%          |                                                                                                                                                                     |
| J.K. Dobbins    | RB | -4 | 57%<br>AVOID | played 10 of 17 games last year · nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 164 points to whoever wins it · Boone and Harmon rank him 28 spots earlier than the market |

Down here the top two choices are separated by **a third of a point per season**. That is not a small edge, it is **no edge** — the numbers have run out of ability to tell these players apart. When the math can't decide, something else has to, and the only thing we have actually measured is **who gets the job**. When a receiver's target count jumps, 93% of that is his own share of the offence and only 7% is his team throwing more. So: find the backfield or the slot where nobody has locked down the role yet. **This is where your reading hours are worth something.**

PICK 104 · the top two are 5.3 points apart over the whole season (0.38 a week) **TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday**

|                 |    |     |     |       |                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|----|-----|-----|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mark Andrews    | TE | 0   | 42% |       |                                                                                                                                  |
| Kyle Monangai   | RB | -5  | 47% | AVOID | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 196 points to whoever wins it · sweep expects him to miss 4 games                         |
| Dalton Kincaid  | TE | -15 | 59% | hurt  | played 12 of 17 games last year · sweep expects him to miss 2 games · Boone and Harmon rank him 29 spots earlier than the market |
| Aaron Jones Sr. | RB | -15 | 42% |       | played 12 of 17 games last year · nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 153 points to whoever wins it                           |

PICK 113 · the top two are 0.7 points apart over the whole season (0.05 a week) **TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday**

|                        |    |     |     |      |                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------|----|-----|-----|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dalton Kincaid         | TE | -15 | 40% | hurt | played 12 of 17 games last year · sweep expects him to miss 2 games · Boone and Harmon rank him 29 spots earlier than the market                                      |
| Jared Goff             | QB | -15 | 51% |      |                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Jacory Croskey-Merritt | RB | -17 | 45% | hurt | nobody owns this job yet — it is worth 151 points to whoever wins it · sweep expects him to miss 1 games · Boone and Harmon rank him 45 spots earlier than the market |
| Blake Corum            | RB | -18 | 40% |      | someone leads but the backup is close, job worth 215 points · Boone and Harmon rank him 40 spots earlier than the market                                              |

PICK 128 · the top two are 0.4 points apart over the whole season (0.03 a week) **TOO CLOSE TO CALL — settle this one before Sunday**

|                   |    |     |     |      |                                   |
|-------------------|----|-----|-----|------|-----------------------------------|
| Kenyon Sadiq      | TE | -18 | 55% | hurt | sweep expects him to miss 1 games |
| Hunter Henry      | TE | -18 | 42% |      |                                   |
| Brenton Strange   | TE | -27 | 76% |      | played 12 of 17 games last year   |
| Terrance Ferguson | TE | -27 | 75% |      | played 11 of 17 games last year   |

PICK 137 · the top two are 9.5 points apart over the whole season (0.68 a week) **leaning, but not settled**

|                   |    |     |     |      |                                   |
|-------------------|----|-----|-----|------|-----------------------------------|
| Kenyon Sadiq      | TE | -18 | 38% | hurt | sweep expects him to miss 1 games |
| Brenton Strange   | TE | -27 | 62% |      | played 12 of 17 games last year   |
| Terrance Ferguson | TE | -27 | 60% |      | played 11 of 17 games last year   |
| Juwan Johnson     | TE | -28 | 50% |      |                                   |